



Fostex 8 Track DAT Recorder

As mentioned earlier, the CD format was an exceptional format for both audio and data storage but with plummeting prices and more competition, mediocrity inevitably crept into the quality of the media. Also, with the penetration of the Internet in the '90s, another revolution was silently taking form in the digital era.

Nevertheless, before we talk about the digital revolution in its truest sense, there were other worthy adversaries. Prominent amongst these was the Digital Audio Tape or DAT for short. This technology was introduced in 1987 but was limited to the professional community and some consumers. The primary reason for this was the cost (again!). From the perspective of studios, DAT offered digital storage capabilities at relatively low costs, but these costs were too high for the masses. Another factor that made DAT recorders favourable for studios was the fact that it was regarded as a professional digital format used for original mastering and therefore bypasses the SCMS (Serial Copy Management System), allowing multi-generation, lossless digital recordings.